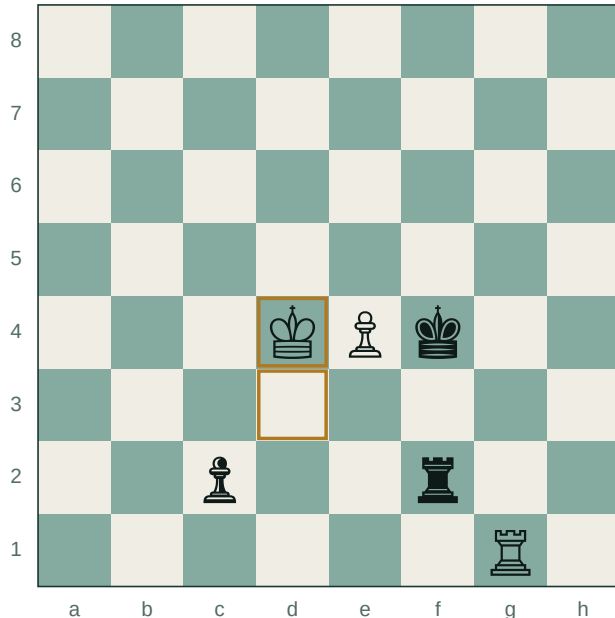


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 59

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 59.Kxd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

59...Rd2+ 60. Kc3 Rd1 61. Kxc2 Rxc2

59...Rd2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **60.Kc3**.

60...Rd1 The rook moves from d2 to d1. Recorded reply: **61.Kxc2**.

61...Rxc2 The rook captures the rook on c2.

At the end, nominal material is White 1 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4**: the balance goes from +0 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on d4. Geometrically undefended: rook on g1. Check for tactical protection.